

SEO Strategy & Action Plan

Creative Blinds & Drapes · creativeblindsdrapes.com
Aurora, IL

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This document covers both the strategic direction (WHY and WHAT we will win) and the execution plan (HOW and WHEN). It is a living document, updated monthly as results come in.

1. Current Situation

Creative Blinds & Drapes is a new, family-owned window treatment showroom operating from 850 S Frontenac Street, Aurora, IL. The business carries genuine competitive advantages: 23+ years of parent-company installation experience through Creative Floors Inc., an exclusive Adeko Turkish fabric range with 70+ drapery and 50+ sheer options, and a premium free in-home consultation model. None of these strengths are currently visible or rankable in organic search.

The SEO audit of creativeblindsdrapes.com reveals a technically functional but strategically incomplete website. The site is clean on the fundamentals (no 4xx errors, HTTPS secured, clean redirect stack), yet it fails to generate commercial enquiries because critical on-page, structural, and local search elements are absent. Specifically:

- The About page has no H1 tag, a basic on-page failure that signals weak page relevance to Google.
- Two key service pages (Custom Drapes and Curtains, Sheer Curtains) are orphaned from the main navigation, meaning Google's crawler cannot reliably discover them.
- The curtains.php page contains 142 links, well above the recommended threshold of 100, which dilutes PageRank distribution across the site.
- Ten pages carry meta descriptions exceeding 160 characters, resulting in truncated, unprofessional-looking snippets in the SERPs.
- Mobile LCP (Largest Contentful Paint) requires improvement, which directly suppresses the site's Core Web Vitals score and may limit rankings on mobile queries, the dominant channel for home improvement research.
- The website has no service-area pages, no blog, no FAQ sections, and no schema markup. All are prerequisites for ranking in the competitive Fox Valley window treatment market.

The target of 20 qualified organic leads per month is achievable within six months, but only if the site is rebuilt as a complete local SEO machine rather than a static digital brochure. That is the purpose of this plan.

Audit Status Summary

Issue Area	Status	Business Impact
About page no H1 tag	ERROR	Reduced page relevance; lower rankings for branded/local queries
Orphaned service pages (2 pages)	ERROR	Pages not linked internally Google may not crawl or index them
Curtains page: 142 outbound links	ERROR	PageRank dilution; poor user experience signal
10 pages with meta descriptions > 160 chars	ERROR	Truncated SERP snippets reduce click-through rates

Mobile LCP requires improvement	WARNING	Core Web Vitals signal; may suppress mobile rankings
No service-area pages	MISSING	Zero visibility for 'drapes Naperville', 'blinds Geneva' etc.
No blog / content hub	MISSING	No organic traffic from buyer-research queries
No FAQ or schema markup	MISSING	No People Also Ask positions; AI Overviews unlikely to cite site
No CTAs / click-to-call buttons	VISUAL	Visitors cannot convert; leads go to competitors instead

2. How We Will Win

The window treatment market in the Fox Valley corridor sits between two extremes: national chains (The Shade Store, 3 Day Blinds, Blinds To Go) with large budgets and generic local presence, and individual installers with no online footprint at all. Creative Blinds and Drapes occupies the gap in the middle as the premium, locally rooted specialist with real showroom experience and exclusive fabrics that national chains cannot match.

Strategic Principle

We outrank national chains through hyper-local specificity and genuine first-party content that cannot be replicated. We outrank local independents through content depth and completeness. The strategic foundation rests on three pillars:

- **Local Authority:** Dominate 'custom drapes Aurora IL' and adjacent service-area queries before national chains can respond with localised pages.
- **Content Depth:** Produce the most useful, consultative window treatment content in the Fox Valley market, targeting every stage of the buyer journey.
- **Trust Signals:** Make the 23-year family history, Illinois contractor licence, and Adeko exclusive range the most prominent trust elements on every page.

Target Buyer Profiles

Buyer Type	What They Search	What We Give Them
New homeowner planning décor	'custom drapes Aurora IL', 'window treatments near me'	Service + location pages with portfolio photos and free consultation CTA
Homeowner researching options	'drapery vs curtains', 'how to choose window treatments'	Educational guides that qualify them into our services
Premium buyer comparing suppliers	'custom shades Naperville', 'Hunter Douglas dealer'	Brand + product pages demonstrating Adeko exclusive range
Returning homeowner / renovator	'drapery installation service near me', 'custom blinds Batavia'	Service-area pages with before/after photos and reviews

3. Priority Keywords

Keyword selection is driven by three filters: commercial intent (the searcher is ready to enquire or buy), geographic match (Aurora plus the seven named service communities), and competitive gap (positions where national chains underperform on local specificity). The table below presents the prioritised keyword clusters with indicative data. Exact volumes and difficulty scores will be validated in Google Search Console and keyword tools during Month 1.

Keyword Cluster	Primary Target Keyword	Intent
Custom Drapery (Aurora)	custom drapes Aurora IL	Transactional
Drapery Installation	drapery installation service Aurora	Transactional
Sheer Curtains	custom sheer curtains Aurora IL	Commercial
Window Blinds Local	custom window blinds Aurora IL	Commercial
Window Shades	custom window shades Aurora IL	Commercial
Service Area Naperville	window treatments Naperville IL	Commercial
Service Area Oswego / Yorkville	custom blinds Oswego IL	Commercial
Service Area Batavia / Geneva / St. Charles	window treatments Geneva IL	Commercial
Service Area Plainfield	custom drapes Plainfield IL	Commercial
Buyer Research How To Choose	how to choose window treatments	Informational
Buyer Research Cost	how much do custom drapes cost	Informational
Product Authority Adeko	Adeko curtain fabrics USA	Navigational

4. What We Are Building

The website architecture must reflect how premium window treatment buyers actually search. Customers do not just search for 'window treatments' they search for a specific product in a specific location at a specific stage of their decision journey. Every page we build maps to a specific search intent and service community.

Page Architecture

Page Type	URL Pattern	Target Keyword Type
Service hubs (x5)	/drapes/, /blinds/, /shades/ etc.	Service + generic
Service × city pages (×7+)	/drapes-aurora-il/, /blinds-naperville/ etc.	Service + location
Homepage rewrite	/	Brand + primary city
About page (new)	/about/	Trust / E-E-A-T signals
Product / brand pages	/adeko-fabrics/	Brand + product searches
Educational guides (×2/mo)	/guides/[topic]/	Research + informational
FAQs embedded on all service pages	On each service + location page	PAA positions, AI Overviews

Orphan Page Resolution

The audit confirmed that /drapes-curtains.php and /sheer-curtains.php are orphaned from the main navigation. These pages are in the sitemap and indexed by Google, yet receive no internal link equity. Resolution in Month 1: add both pages to the primary navigation and cross-link them from service hub pages.

Link Overload Fix curtains.php

The curtains.php page carries 142 internal links, which is 42 above the 100-link quality threshold. The primary cause is likely an unfiltered fabric PDF library rendered as links. Recommended fix: replace individual PDF links with a single 'View Full Fabric Range' page or a filtered product gallery that renders links only on demand. This also improves user experience and conversion.

5. Technical Fixes

Technical fixes must be completed before content work scales. Building new pages on a site with structural on-page errors wastes authority and budget. The table below sequences fixes by priority and month.

Task	What & Why	Done
Add H1 to About page	The About page has 0 H1 tags. Add a keyword-rich H1 such as: Custom Window Treatments in Aurora, IL Creative Blinds and Drapes	
Fix orphan pages in nav	Link /drapes-curtains.php and /sheer-curtains.php from main navigation and cross-link from service hubs	
Fix meta descriptions (10 pages)	Rewrite all 10 over-length meta descriptions to under 155 chars. About.php and Contact.php are worst offenders (181 chars each).	
Reduce curtains.php link count	Replace individual PDF fabric links with a consolidated gallery page. Target: under 80 links.	
LocalBusiness schema on homepage	Implement JSON-LD LocalBusiness schema with name, address, phone, openingHours, areaServed (all 8 cities), and priceRange.	
Service schema on all service pages	Each service page: Service name, provider, areaServed, description. Targets AI Overview citations.	
FAQPage schema on all service pages	3-5 FAQs per page in JSON-LD. Targets PAA positions and AI Overviews.	
Submit XML sitemap to GSC	Verify sitemap includes all live pages. Currently orphan pages are in the sitemap but not in the navigation. Resolve this conflict before content builds.	
Mobile LCP improvement brief	Compress all hero images to WebP format. Lazy-load below-fold images. Target LCP < 2.5s on mobile. Brief to site developer (standalone PHP/HTML site).	
Implement click-to-call on all pages	Phone number (630) 946-1406 must be tap-to-call on mobile. Currently near-invisible per visual audit.	
Add contact form to all service pages	Visual audit shows missing form submission option. Each service page should have an embedded enquiry form.	
Review schema validity in GSC	Check Schema Markup report in Google Search Console for invalid items flagged in visual audit. Fix before content launches.	

6. Local SEO

For a premium window treatment showroom serving a defined 20-mile radius, Local SEO is the highest-ROI activity in the plan. The Local Pack (Google Maps results) typically appears above organic results for 'window treatments near me' and city-modifier queries. Securing Top 3 Local Pack positions in Aurora, Naperville, and Oswego is an early priority.

Google Business Profile

Creative Blinds and Drapes has a dedicated, verified Google Business Profile in place, which is a solid foundation for Local Pack visibility. Access has been confirmed. The focus now is on completing and optimising the profile to maximise ranking signals and convert profile views into enquiries.

GBP Optimisation Checklist

- Business name: Creative Blinds & Drapes (verify exact match across all listings)
- Profile type: Storefront with showroom address (850 S Frontenac St, Aurora, IL 60504)
- Service area: Aurora + 20-mile radius (Naperville, Oswego, Yorkville, Batavia, Geneva, St. Charles, Plainfield). Confirm all 8 communities are listed.
- Primary category: Window Treatment Store. Secondary: Interior Decorator, Blind and Shade Dealer. Review and update if not already set.
- Services: Every service listed individually with descriptions. Custom Drapes, Sheer Curtains, Blinds, Shades, Curtain Hardware, Free In-Home Consultation
- Hours: Mon-Fri 9am-6pm, Sat 10am-1pm (plus 'by appointment' note for evenings/weekends)
- Photos: Minimum 20 showroom and installation photos. Add 5-10 new photos monthly.
- GBP Posts: 2 per week covering installation project completions, seasonal room inspiration, and fabric range highlights
- Q&A: Seed 8 questions and answers (e.g. 'Do you offer free in-home consultation?', 'Do you carry Turkish fabrics?')
- Reviews: Request via text/email within 48 hours of every completed installation. Target: 5+ new reviews in the first phase, 15+ cumulative within 3 months.

Citations & NAP Consistency

NAP (Name, Address, Phone) consistency across directories is a ranking factor for the Local Pack. A citation audit will verify that all existing directory entries correctly display Creative Blinds & Drapes details before new listings are built.

- Priority directories: Bing Places, Apple Maps, Yelp, Angi, HomeAdvisor, Houzz, Thumbtack
- Local directories: Aurora Chamber of Commerce, Naperville Chamber, Illinois business directories
- Industry: Hunter Douglas dealer directory, Norman Window Fashions dealer network, Houzz Pro

7. Content Architecture & Clustering

The content model follows a hub-and-spoke architecture. Each service hub page (e.g. /curtains/) is the authoritative parent that ranks for the broadest version of each keyword. Spoke pages (service-area pages, product sub-pages, buyer guides) feed link equity into the hub and rank for more specific long-tail queries. All internal links use descriptive anchor text rather than generic phrases like 'click here' or 'read more'.

Content Cluster Map

Hub Page	Spoke Pages (service-area + sub-topics)	Supporting Guides
/curtains/ (Custom Drapes & Curtains)	/drapes-aurora-il/, /drapes-naperville/, /drapes-oswego/, /drapes-batavia-geneva-st-charles/	How to Choose Between Drapes and Curtains; How Much Do Custom Drapes Cost in Illinois?
/sheer-curtains/ (Sheer Curtains)	/sheer-curtains-aurora/, /sheer-curtains-naperville/	What Are Sheer Curtains? A Homeowner's Guide; Sheer vs Blackout: Which Is Right for Each Room?
/blinds/ (Window Blinds)	/blinds-aurora-il/, /blinds-naperville/, /blinds-plainfield/	Faux Wood vs Real Wood Blinds: Which Is Better for Illinois Homes?
/curtain-hardware/ (Curtain Hardware)	/curtain-hardware-aurora/, /curtain-rods-aurora/	Curtain Hardware Guide: Rods, Rings and Tracks Explained
/shades/ (Window Shades)	/shades-aurora-il/, /roller-shades-aurora/	Honeycomb vs Roller Shades: Which Saves More Energy in Illinois Winters?
/adeko-fabrics/ (Adeko Brand Page)	Sub-pages by fabric collection (optional Month 3+)	Why Turkish Fabrics Outperform Standard Drapery Materials (with Adeko examples)

Content Standards for All Pages

- Minimum 600 words for service pages. Minimum 900 words for service-area pages. Guides: 1,000-1,400 words.
- H1 must contain the primary keyword. H2s should use secondary and LSI keywords.
- Each service page must include: product/service description, process section (consultation to installation), FAQ block (minimum 4 questions), social proof (at minimum the existing verified review), and a prominent enquiry form or click-to-call CTA.
- Every page links to at least 2 related service pages and 1 relevant guide (internal linking).
- All guides end with a CTA linking to the relevant service page ('Ready to see our fabric range in person? Book your free in-home consultation.')
- Images: every service page to include at least 2 installation photos with descriptive alt text (e.g. 'custom drapery installation Aurora IL living room').

8. Content Calendar

Two guides are published per month from the outset. All guides follow the structural standards above. Priority is given to buyer-research queries that attract premium homeowners mid-journey, people who know they want custom treatments but have not yet chosen a supplier.

Article Title Target Keyword	Search Intent	Target Hub Page
How to Choose Custom Drapes vs Ready-Made: A Homeowner's Guide 'custom drapes vs ready-made'	Research	/curtains/
How Much Do Custom Window Treatments Cost in Illinois? (2026 Guide) 'custom window treatment cost Illinois'	Research	/curtains/
Sheer Curtains vs Blackout: Which Fabric Works in Each Room? 'sheer vs blackout curtains'	Informational	/sheer-curtains/
Faux Wood vs Real Wood Blinds: Which Is Better for Illinois Homes? 'faux wood vs wood blinds'	Informational	/blinds/
Roman Shades vs Roller Shades: Which Works Better in Illinois Homes? 'roman shades vs roller shades'	Commercial	/shades/
What Are Turkish Fabrics and Why Do They Make Better Drapes? 'Turkish curtain fabrics'	Informational	/adeko-fabrics/
Honeycomb vs Roller Shades: Energy Efficiency Guide for Illinois Winters 'honeycomb vs roller shades'	Informational	/shades/
What Happens During a Free In-Home Window Treatment Consultation? 'window treatment consultation what to expect'	Research	Homepage / About
How to Measure Windows for Custom Curtains (Step-by-Step) 'how to measure for custom curtains'	Informational	/curtains/
The Best Window Treatments for Naperville New-Build Homes 'window treatments Naperville new build'	Commercial	/drapes-naperville/
Curtain Hardware Guide: Rods, Rings & Tracks Explained 'curtain hardware types'	Informational	/curtain-hardware/
Custom Window Treatments for Open-Plan Homes in Aurora, IL 'window treatments open plan Aurora'	Commercial	/drapes-aurora-il/

9. Execution Plan

The engagement runs across five phases, from initial setup to ongoing building and growing. The sequence below follows the standard Little Red SEO onboarding timeline. Technical foundations and strategy approval come first. No content pages go live until the structural issues identified in the audit are resolved.

#	Phase & When	What You Do	What I Deliver
1	Getting Started Days 1-3	Questionnaire is complete. Platform access (GA4, GSC, GBP) confirmed as provided.	Confirm all access is working. Flag anything to clarify before research begins.
2	Kickoff Call Days 4-5	30-40 minute video call. No preparation needed. Just arrive with any questions.	Send meeting link once access is confirmed. Share written summary of agreed priorities within 24 hours.
3	Research & Architecture Weeks 1-2	Nothing required. Reply to any follow-up questions within one business day.	Full keyword research across all services and service-area cities. Page architecture designed. Full technical audit using GA4, GSC, and site crawl.
4	First Deliverables Weeks 2-4	Review the Strategy & Action Plan. Send feedback or questions within 5 days. One revision round included. Review rewritten service pages. Check all service details, tone, and CTAs are accurate. Approve or request edits within 3 business days per batch.	Strategy & Action Plan document delivered (this document). All existing service pages rewritten: 600-900 words each, FAQs, trust signals, CTAs. Schema implementation: LocalBusiness, Service, and FAQPage structured data on all key pages. Technical fixes from audit applied.
5	Building & Growing Month 2 onwards	Review 2 educational guide drafts per month. Approve or request edits within 3 business days. Supply case study material: project description, outcome, photos if available.	Location pages (7+ service x city combinations) live. GBP optimisation: profile audit and completion, post schedule active (2/week), review campaign launched, Q&A seeded, NAP citation audit and directory submissions. 2 educational guides published per month, all with FAQPage schema and internal links to service pages. Link building: Houzz Pro, Norman Window Fashions dealer page, local directories. Target 3-5 referring domains per quarter.

10. KPIs & Reporting

The primary success metric is qualified organic enquiries: phone calls from organic search and form submissions from non-branded visitors who arrive via the service or service-area pages. All other metrics (rankings, sessions, GBP calls) are leading indicators that predict whether enquiries will follow.

Metric	Baseline	3-Month Target	6-Month Target
Organic enquiries (forms + tracked calls)	~0 / month	5-8 / month	15-20 / month
Page 1 rankings service + location	0 pages	5+ pages	10+ pages
Local Pack appearances (Aurora + Naperville)	Establish at kickoff	Appearing in both cities	Top 3 in Aurora; Top 5 in Naperville
GBP calls per month	Record at engagement start	+50% vs baseline	+150% vs baseline
Google review count	Record at engagement start	+15 reviews	+40 reviews
Referring domains	Establish in M1	+8 domains	+20 domains

Reporting Schedule

- Weekly: keyword ranking snapshot in shared Google Sheet (Little Red SEO provides template)
- Monthly: written report covering organic leads, sessions, GBP calls, keyword movements, links built, and next month's deliverables
- Monthly: 30-minute review call covering results vs. targets and scope adjustments if needed
- Month 3: mid-point review with formal assessment of results vs. targets; content direction adjusted based on what is ranking
- Month 6: full audit + results presentation + Month 7-12 roadmap

Data Access Requirements

To deliver accurate reporting from Day 1, Little Red SEO requires the following access before the kickoff call. These were noted as provided in the onboarding questionnaire, and should be confirmed active before Month 1 work commences.

Platform	Access Level Required	Status (per Onboarding)
Google Analytics 4	Editor or Admin	Provided

Google Search Console	Full User or Owner	Provided
Google Business Profile (dedicated Creative Blinds & Drapes profile)	Manager or Owner	Provided
Call tracking (CallRail or equivalent)	Admin	Not yet active recommend setting up at kickoff

Questions or revisions to this plan? Contact: help@littleredseo.com | littleredseo.com

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